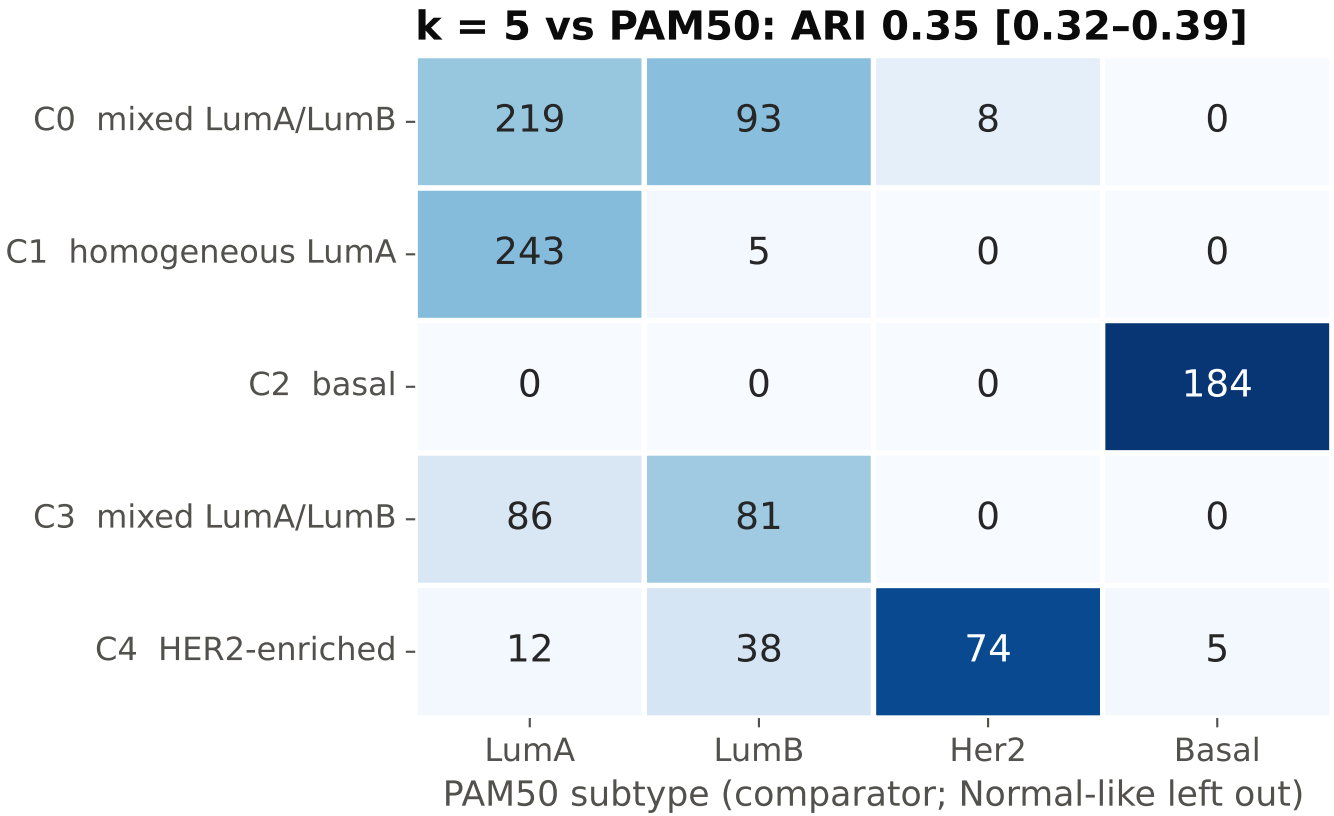
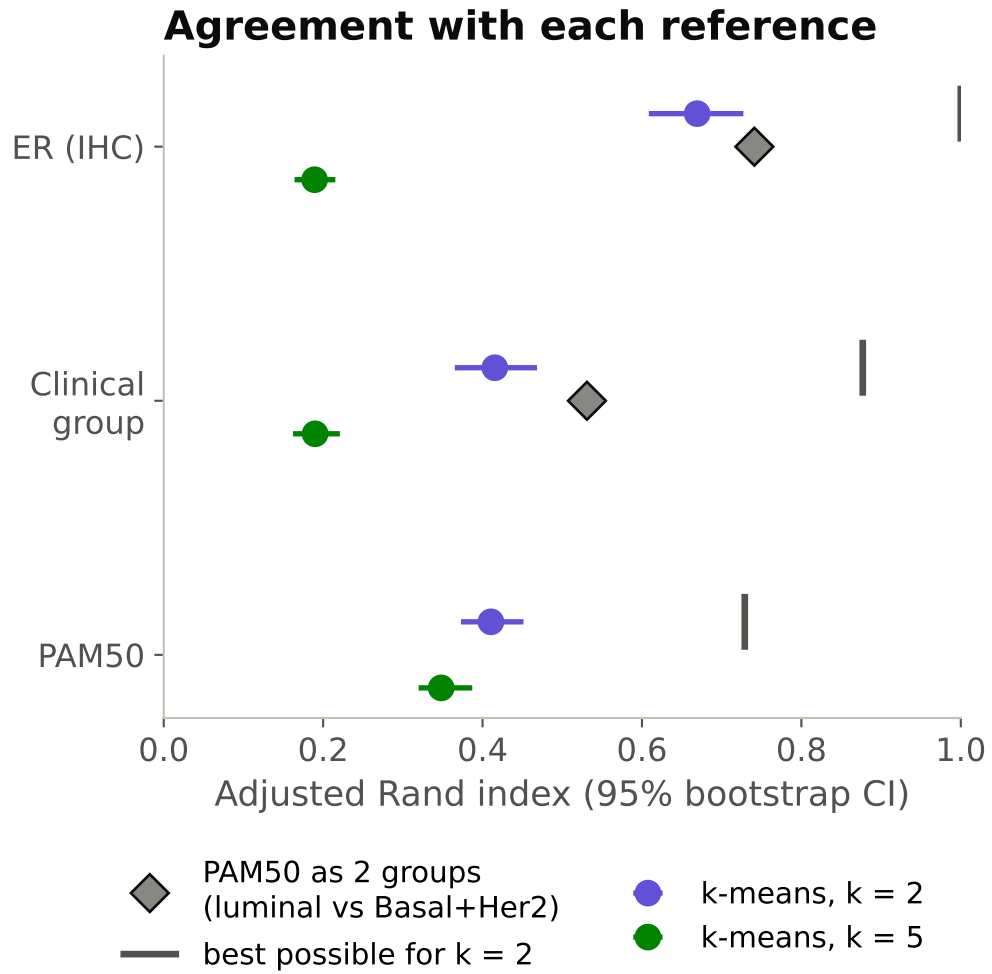
Label-free clustering is most stable at k = 2: a basal-like group of 217 tumours splits off

It holds 188/189 PAM50 Basal, 138/157 TNBC and 179/235 ER-negative tumours

Finer clusters (k = 5) also recover a HER2-enriched group but split luminal tumours differently from PAM50

1,088 tumours, 2,000 most variable genes, PAM50 genes left out. k = 5 is less stable than k = 2 (PAC 0.14 vs 0.02; ARI 0.67 against a 5,000-gene rerun).





Heatmap: cell = count, shade = share of each PAM50 column. Row names: closest Netanely 2016 K = 5 cluster by majority PAM50 class (a heuristic, not their assignment; they also clustered adjacent normals).